

Founder Bottleneck Diagnostic

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The short version

One 90-minute session. We find the thing that's actually holding you back, not the thing you walked in thinking it was. Most founders show up already sure of the problem, "my team's slow," "marketing isn't working," "I can't focus." Usually that's not it, that's just the symptom. We find what's under it.

Who's behind it

I'm Trung. Before this, 10+ years in engineering, mostly infrastructure, including Contentful and Workpath. At Workpath I ran infra, and what my team built there is a big part of why the company could run six product teams shipping at once.

I'm not a coach and I'm not a consultant who does a bit of everything. Systems, theory of constraints, security, infra, that's the background. What I do for a founder now is basically what I used to do for a broken system: find where it's actually stuck, not where it looks stuck.

A peer from that time put it well:

"Trung excels at seeing the big picture for our team and where we can and should focus our resources. A great sparring partner for any kind of topic."

Martin, engineering peer at Workpath

Who it helps

Usually founders with 3 to 30 people, past MVP, a year or more in, with actual revenue or users. Something feels off and they can't quite name it. A lot of the time they quietly suspect they're the bottleneck themselves.

Two situations I see a lot. One: things are already running, team feels slow, priorities are everywhere, founder's stuck inside their own machine. Two: they just raised or just started spending, about to hire, scared of an expensive mistake they can't see coming yet. Different setup, same underlying thing.

Simplest way to put it: they're confidently wrong about their own bottleneck, and stuck because of it. That's who this is for.

Probably not for you if you're still at idea stage with no team or product, if you want someone to tell you you're doing fine, or if you're after ongoing coaching. This is one session. On purpose.

Does it actually work

Fair question, especially if we haven't worked together. A few real ones:

"Your question-asking approach helped me save 10 to 15 hours of nonsense outreach."

Minh, founder of Algomate

"It's like going to the doctor to get a scan you've never had before and you find out problems you didn't know you had."

Founder, early-stage public speaking platform (the result landed six months after the session, not the same week)

"You are good at laying things out on a table, like a puzzle, helping someone articulate and see the next necessary steps. There's never any awkwardness, no games."

Chris, founder of mindtv (we didn't end up working together, he said this seven months later)

"You already know something, but it hits when someone says it to you straight. Sometimes you just need to take your medicine."

Johnny Harris, founder of Dai Viet Rugby

What you walk out with

Usually: the thing to stop doing, said plainly. One to three real priorities instead of a long list. A decision you'd been sitting on, made. The number you'd been avoiding, finally on the table.

That's basically the whole thing, honestly, not a 40-page plan. If it worked, you should be able to say it back to your co-founder in one sentence.

How it works

Remote, 90 minutes. Price gets set in the conversation, not before it, depends what we find. If you want to feel it out first, a short coffee chat's free, no pitch.

Know someone this sounds like? Forward it. If it's you, just reach out and we'll figure out if it's a fit. If it's not, I'll say so.

Live version: iamtrung.com/d/diagnostic-handout